

Eliana Coschignano

Researcher / PhD Candidate in Economics

RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Berlin

eliana.coschignano@rwi-essen.de

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Public Economics, Unemployment Insurance, Welfare Policy, Labor Markets, Applied Microeconomics

Education

TU Dortmund University 2024 – present

Ph.D. in Economics

Heidelberg University 2018 – 2021

M.Sc. in Economics

Thesis: “The Gender Wage Gap in Italy: Evidence from Quantile Regression”.

Durham University 2015 – 2018

B.A. in Economics

Thesis: “The Impact of Criminal Organizations on GDP per Capita in Calabria”.

Professional Experience

RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Berlin 09/2023 – present

Researcher

- Conduct empirical research on the effects of welfare reforms and labor-market policies using administrative and survey data.
- Apply econometric methods to study unemployment, earnings, labor-market transitions, and the distributional effects of policy reforms.
- Conduct labor-market forecasting for the German economy.
- Represented RWI in the labor-market group of the Joint Economic Forecast 2025.

European Central Bank, Frankfurt am Main 04/2022 – 03/2023

Analyst, Directorate Banknotes

- Managed and oversaw data collection, cleaning, and validation for surveys on cash usage and payment behavior.
- Main drafter and data analyst for the [Study on the payment attitudes of consumers in the euro area \(SPACE\)](#) and [Use of cash by companies in the euro area](#).
- Analyzed trends in cash usage and other economic indicators using Python and R.

European Central Bank, Frankfurt am Main 04/2021 – 03/2022

Trainee, Directorate Banknotes

- Contributed to research on cash accessibility and financial inclusion in underserved regions of the euro area.
- Developed policy indicators and contributed to analytical and policy reports.
- Managed an in-house database monitoring the issuance, stock, and circulation of euro banknotes and coins.

Research Visits

Boston University 09/2026 – 11/2026

Visiting Scholar

Working Papers

- **Coschignano, Eliana and Robin Jessen** (2025). “The Diverging Trends of Male and Female Bottom Earnings in Germany.” *Revise and Resubmit, Review of Income and Wealth*.
- **Zamora-Pérez, Alejandro, Eliana Coschignano and Laura Barreiro** (2022). “Ensuring Adoption of Central Bank Digital Currencies – an Easy Task or a Gordian Knot?” *ECB Occasional Paper No. 2022/307*.

Teaching

Humboldt University of Berlin

2026 – 2027

Teaching Assistant

Taxation and the Welfare State, graduate-level course on tax policy and welfare-state institutions.

Hertie School, Berlin

2025 – 2026

Lead Teaching Assistant

Advanced Economics: Concepts and Policy Applications, graduate-level applied microeconomics course covering tax policy, inequality, welfare programs, minimum wages, and behavioral policy tools.

Conferences, Workshops and Seminars

- **2026:** European Society for Population Economics (ESPE) Conference; Boston University Economics Applied Micro Workshop.
- **2025:** Inequalities and Opportunities, University of Bari; 11th Conference of the Society for the Study of Economic Inequality (ECINEQ).
- **2024:** Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE); International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF); Verein für Socialpolitik (VfS); SOEP Brown Bag Seminar.

Skills

Programming: Stata, R, Python

Other: L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office, Tableau

Languages: Italian, English, German